

AJAY DHAGE

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Technical Lead | Senior DevOps Engineer | SRE | Kubernetes | AWS | Terraform | Platform Engineering

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps / Site Reliability Engineer (SRE) with **5+ years of total experience** (4+ years in DevOps/SRE, 1+ year as Technical Lead) designing, automating, and operating **cloud-native microservices architecture** on **AWS, Azure, and GCP**. Expert in **Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE)**, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, ArgoCD, FluxCD), **Infrastructure as Code & Infrastructure Automation** (Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation), and **DevSecOps** (Trivy, Falco, OPA Gatekeeper, Snyk, Vault). Manages production EKS clusters delivering **99.95% uptime** and **high availability** at ~5,000 TPS. Reduced **MTTR by 35%**, release cycles by **60%**, and infrastructure costs by **25%**. Proficient in **Python, Bash scripting**, and enterprise tooling: Datadog, PagerDuty, Jira, ServiceNow, Confluence. Strong track record in disaster recovery, vulnerability management, scalability, compliance, stakeholder management, and root cause analysis.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms:	AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, RDS, ALB/NLB, Route 53, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Lambda, ECS/Fargate, SNS, SQS) — 4+ yrs Azure (AKS, Azure DevOps, Azure Monitor) — 3+ yrs GCP (GKE, Cloud Build, Stackdriver) — 2+ yrs
Containers & Orchestration:	Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE) — 4+ yrs Docker — 4+ yrs Helm, Kustomize — 3+ yrs OpenShift, HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, Pod Disruption Budgets, Topology Spread Constraints
CI/CD & GitOps:	Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD — 4+ yrs ArgoCD, ArgoCD Rollouts, FluxCD, Flagger — 3+ yrs Azure Pipelines, Bamboo, TeamCity, JFrog Artifactory, Trunk-Based Development
Infrastructure as Code:	Terraform (modules, workspaces, remote state, Sentinel) — 4+ yrs Ansible — 3+ yrs CloudFormation — 2+ yrs Packer, Crossplane, Pulumi
Service Mesh & Networking:	Istio, Linkerd — 2+ yrs Envoy, Nginx Ingress, HAProxy, AWS ALB/NLB, Route 53, mTLS, SSL/TLS, Zero-Trust Networking, eBPF, TCP/IP, HTTP/HTTPS
Security & DevSecOps:	IAM/RBAC, OPA Gatekeeper, Falco, Trivy, Snyk, SonarQube, Veracode, Clair, HashiCorp Vault, AWS Secrets Manager, SAST/DAST, CIS Benchmarks, Pod Security Standards, Cosign (image signing)
Observability & Monitoring:	Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager — 4+ yrs ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) — 3+ yrs Datadog, Splunk, Dynatrace, New Relic, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, Distributed Tracing, SLI/SLO/Error Budgets
Incident & ITSM:	PagerDuty, ServiceNow, Jira, Confluence, Opsgenie — 3+ yrs P0/P1 Incident Management, On-Call Rotation, RCA / Postmortems, ITIL, Blameless Culture
Scripting & Programming:	Bash / Shell Scripting — 5+ yrs Python — 3+ yrs YAML, JSON — 4+ yrs Groovy (Jenkinsfile) — 3+ yrs Go (basic) — 1+ yr
Databases & Messaging:	MySQL, PostgreSQL — 3+ yrs MongoDB, Redis — 2+ yrs Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ — 2+ yrs
Reliability Engineering:	SLA/SLO/SLI, Error Budgets, Capacity Planning, Chaos Engineering, Disaster Recovery (DR), High Availability (HA/DR), Blue/Green, Canary, Rolling Deployments, Autoscaling, Scalability, Distributed Systems, Cost Optimization — 4+ yrs
Methodologies:	Agile / Scrum, SAFe, DevOps, DevSecOps, GitOps, SRE Principles, ITIL Incident Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead - Platform Engineering & Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Oct 2024 - Present | **1+ yr 8 mos**

- Lead and mentor a team of 3 DevOps/SRE engineers; drive cross-functional collaboration with Product, QA, and Operations for zero-downtime platform delivery.
- Own Kubernetes production clusters (10-20 EKS worker nodes, 45+ microservices, 200+ pods) processing ~5,000 TPS across dev/staging/prod with 99.95% SLA.
- Defined SLA/SLO/SLI metrics, error budgets, and Prometheus-based alerting rules; reduced MTTR by 35% and eliminated 40% of alert noise through runbook automation.
- Led P0/P1 incident response war-room calls and root cause analysis (RCA); coordinated multi-team rollback for UPS production deployment; delivered structured postmortems with stakeholder-facing action plans in Jira/Confluence.

- Implemented Blue/Green and Canary deployment strategies using ArgoCD Rollouts and Flagger with automated rollback on SLO breach — zero failed production releases in 6 months.
- Designed multi-region HA/DR architecture (us-east-1 + ap-south-1) with cross-region RDS replication, S3 versioning, and automated failover; achieved RPO < 1 hr, RTO < 30 min.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning and infrastructure automation via Terraform modules and GitOps (ArgoCD); eliminated drift, improved scalability, reduced provisioning time by 70%.
- Implemented DevSecOps pipeline for vulnerability management: Trivy (container scanning), Falco (runtime threat detection), OPA Gatekeeper (policy enforcement & compliance), Snyc (CVEs) — 100% policy-compliant deployments.
- Optimised HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler; right-sized 45 workloads; reduced monthly AWS spend by 25% (\$18K/month savings).
- Integrated Datadog APM and PagerDuty for real-time alerting and on-call scheduling; reduced mean time to acknowledge (MTTA) by 50%.
- Wrote Python and Bash automation scripts for incident runbooks, capacity planning reports, and cost anomaly detection.

Senior Engineer - DevOps / Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Feb 2023 - Sept 2024 | **1 yr 7 mos**

- Architected a Kubernetes-based messaging platform processing 50M+ API transactions/day with auto-scaling and multi-AZ high availability.
- Built CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI) with parallel test execution, JFrog Artifactory, Trivy/Snyk scanning, and zero-downtime deployments; cut release cycle by 60%.
- Configured Nginx Ingress, AWS ALB/NLB, Route 53 DNS routing, SSL/TLS termination, and WAF rules; enforced least-privilege IAM/RBAC policies across all environments.
- Deployed centralised observability stack (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Alertmanager, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry) for full-stack metrics, log aggregation, and distributed tracing.
- Evaluated and implemented Istio and Linkerd service mesh for east-west traffic management, mTLS, and advanced load balancing; reduced inter-service latency by 15%.
- Integrated HashiCorp Vault and AWS Secrets Manager for dynamic secrets injection — eliminated hardcoded credentials from all 45+ services.
- Authored 20+ reusable Terraform modules for VPC, EKS, RDS, and IAM across 3 AWS accounts; enforced Sentinel governance policies.
- Managed PagerDuty on-call schedules and ServiceNow incident tickets; reduced MTTR from 45 min to 29 min over 18 months.
- Developed Python scripts for automated resource tagging, cost reporting, and Slack-based alert notifications.

Engineer - Software Development & DevOps

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Sept 2021 - Jan 2023 | **1 yr 4 mos**

- Developed containerised microservices (Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs) on Kubernetes; authored Dockerfiles, Helm charts, and GitHub Actions pipelines.
- Built automated testing frameworks (unit, integration, regression) in CI pipelines with SonarQube quality gates; reduced production defects by 40%.
- Assisted AWS cloud migration from monolithic architecture to microservices on EKS; improved independent deployability and reduced release coupling.
- Managed AWS resources (EC2, S3, RDS, VPC, IAM) and contributed Terraform changes in Agile/Scrum sprints tracked via Jira and Confluence.
- Wrote Bash and Python scripts for environment setup automation, log parsing, and monitoring configuration.

CMS Web Developer

Simplotel Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Nov 2020 - July 2021 | **9 mos**

- Built and optimised CMS-based web solutions for 15+ hospitality clients; improved page load speed by 30% through caching and frontend tuning.
- Integrated REST APIs, implemented SEO improvements, and delivered UI/UX enhancements in Agile/Scrum sprints via Git version control.

KEY PLATFORM ENGINEERING PROJECTS

Multi-Region EKS HA/DR Platform

AWS, EKS, Route 53, RDS, S3, Terraform, Ansible | Experience: 2+ years

- Active-passive multi-region (us-east-1 / ap-south-1) EKS platform with Route 53 health-check failover, cross-region RDS read replicas, and S3 cross-region replication.
- Automated failover runbook (Python + Bash) achieved RPO < 1 hr and RTO < 30 min; validated quarterly via chaos engineering drills using AWS Fault Injection Simulator.

GitOps Migration & Canary Deployments

- ArgoCD, ArgoCD Rollouts, Flagger, Helm, Kustomize, Prometheus | Experience: 2+ years
- Migrated 45+ microservices from imperative kubectl to full GitOps using ArgoCD with Helm chart versioning and Kustomize overlays.
 - Implemented Canary deployments via Flagger with Prometheus-based SLO gates and automated rollback on error-rate breach; 0 failed prod releases post-migration.

DevSecOps Pipeline Implementation

- Trivy, Falco, OPA Gatekeeper, Snyk, HashiCorp Vault, Cosign, SonarQube | Experience: 3+ years
- Embedded shift-left security: Trivy image scans in CI, Snyk dependency checks, OPA Gatekeeper admission policies, Falco runtime alerts, and Cosign image signing.
 - Achieved 100% policy-compliant deployments; reduced critical CVE exposure by 65% within 3 months of rollout.

Kubernetes Autoscaling & Cost Optimisation

- HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Spot Instances, Python, AWS Cost Explorer | Experience: 2+ years
- Deployed KEDA for event-driven autoscaling on Kafka consumers; Karpenter for intelligent node provisioning; VPA for resource right-sizing across 45 workloads.
 - Reduced monthly AWS compute spend by 25% (~\$18K/month) while maintaining SLO adherence at peak load (5,000 TPS); built Python cost anomaly detection scripts.

Centralised Observability Platform

- Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, PagerDuty | Experience: 3+ years
- Built unified observability: metrics (Prometheus + Grafana), logs (ELK Stack), traces (Jaeger + OpenTelemetry), APM (Datadog) with PagerDuty on-call alerting.
 - Reduced alert noise by 40%, MTTA by 50%; built Python-based SLO reporting dashboards and automated Slack alert notification pipelines.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)	Linux Foundation	In Progress - Target Q3 2026
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C03)	Amazon Web Services	In Progress - Target Q3 2026
HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate	HashiCorp	In Progress - Target Q4 2026
Docker Certified Associate (DCA)	Docker Inc.	In Progress - Target Q4 2026
Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA)	Linux Foundation	In Progress - Target Q4 2026

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & METRICS

- **99.95% SLA** maintained for ~5,000 TPS, 45-microservice Kubernetes production platform across multi-region AWS.
- **35% MTTR reduction** (45 min to 29 min) via SLO-based alerting, automated runbooks, Datadog APM, and PagerDuty.
- **60% faster release cycles** through fully automated CI/CD (Jenkins + GitHub Actions + ArgoCD) with Canary/Blue-Green deployments.
- **25% cloud cost savings** (~\$18K/month) via HPA/VPA/KEDA/Karpenter right-sizing and Reserved Instance planning.
- **65% CVE reduction** in 3 months post DevSecOps pipeline (Trivy + Snyk + OPA Gatekeeper + Cosign).
- **70% faster infrastructure provisioning** via Terraform module automation and GitOps drift elimination.
- **40% reduction in production defects** via automated test frameworks and SonarQube quality gates.
- **50% reduction in MTTA** after integrating Datadog APM with PagerDuty escalation and runbook-linked alerts.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering - Electronics and Communications Engineering

Guru Nanak Dev Engineering College, Bidar, Karnataka, India | 2016 - 2020